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EE/RPF

For use from May/November 2027

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Student personal code:

Extended essay - Reflection and progress form

Student: *This form is to be completed by you and your supervisor during the progress and completion of the extended essay. It records your progress through the extended essay process and includes your reflective statement addressing your extended essay experience. You must undertake three formal reflection sessions with your supervisor: The first formal reflection session should focus on your initial ideas and how you plan to undertake your research; the interim reflection session takes place once a significant amount of your research has been completed, and the final session will be in the form of a viva voce, once you have completed and handed in your extended essay. This document acts as a record in supporting the authenticity of your work. Following the viva voce, you write a* ***reflective statement*** *of no more than 500 words., which must be included on the RPF.*

The completion of this form is a mandatory requirement of the extended essay. It must be submitted together with the completed essay. The reflective statement will then be assessed under Criterion E. Students and supervisors should be aware that a mark of 0 will be awarded by the examiner for criterion E if the RPF is blank or the reflective statement is written in a language other than that of the accompanying essay.

Supervisor: *You must have three reflection sessions with each student, one early in the process, an interim meeting and then the final viva voce. Other check-in sessions are permitted but do not need to be recorded on this sheet. After each reflection session you must record the month that the reflection session took place, the student's year of DP study at that time and initial the form.*
By submitting this student work for assessment, you are taking responsibility for its authenticity. No piece of student work should be uploaded/submitted to the e-Coursework system if its authenticity is in doubt.

First reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Interim reflection session

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

Final reflection session – Viva voce

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

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Reflective statement

(No more than 500 words, written in the same language as the accompanying extended essay)

Participation in an online interschool MUN which focused on ozone depletion was a conscience awakening moment as it propelled me towards narrowing down the topic of my extended essay where an immediate connection could be established between theoretical learning and practical investigation. My concern elevated on further probing through academic articles by Down to Earth which showed the concern of Indian scientists who have been on high alert for any sign of ozone layer depletion over India. On deeper investigation I found that scientific investigative agencies like National Ozone Center in New Delhi also corroborate that the threat looms imminently over India because of unprecedented economic development and consumption of industrial products. Further the most strenuous task was to narrow down the UVA and UV B range of light that could be taken for investigating the impacts on plant productivity and conducting a comparative investigation. Complications were encountered during deeper exploration, as an academic journal by Timothy Zwier of Purdue University suggested that adaptability capacities of plants to UV radiation can vary, so shortlisting the type of plants for investigation posed a challenge. But extensive research articles like “Effect of near ultraviolet and green radiation on plant growth” by Richard M. Klein et al. helped in overcoming the challenges as the investigation suggested that the Brassicaceae plants like Chamomile have better adaptability to UVB radiation due to the presence of components called “sinapate esters” which would block harmful radiation of the sun. The plants will make an effective choice for carrying out a comparative analysis with Gerbera which was chosen based on the keen interest of Rajasthan government and tapping the international market demand for decorative flowers, as shared by Rajasthan agricultural minister Prabhu Lai Sahni.

The extensive research conducted during the course of my EE made me much more compassionate towards such a sensitive issue where man's perennial hunger for development has led to disastrous impacts on the environment. The challenge that I faced prior to writing the EE was never to focus on the nuances and structure of the report but then I realized that following conventions improved the presentation of my EE to a greater extent. The completion of my EE made me feel more knowledgeable in a way that I have gained skills to carry out field experiments, collect data, and evaluate it. The process helped me to pick up exceptional research skills that I never had. Unlike before now I have learnt to differentiate between credible and non-credible sources on the Internet adapting to the validity of my investigations even in my future works. I could definitively conclude from the investigation that substantial links exist between various compounds of our environmental system and how they are affected by anthropogenic activities. I would also advise other students who undertake the extended essay to be clear with the research question from the start as it focused my investigation and allowed me the space to structure the essay with room for adjustments to my plan.

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